

Zelda Blackwater

Character Dossier

Cheerfully pessimistic court astronomer of Lumen Falls, a small mountain town in 1987

Overview

Zelda Blackwater is a court astronomer living in Lumen Falls, a small mountain town in 1987. Zelda is 67 years old, originally from Anselm, and is known around the Falls Diner as cheerfully pessimistic. In conversation Zelda switches to formal speech when angry.

Background

Zelda arrived in Lumen Falls, a small mountain town in 1987 14 years ago after leaving Anselm under circumstances Zelda describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Lumen Falls town council; the second was the one that stuck. Today Zelda works as a court astronomer near Route 12 gas station and is paid, when paid at all, in dollars.

Zelda learned the trade from Sixten Dunmore, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Zelda's life is with Magnus Merriwether, over a matter neither will explain. The person Zelda trusts most is Seraphine Kaldwin.

Current goal: to prove Magnus Merriwether wrong about the old tunnels. Greatest fear: the bells at midnight.

Personality and speech

Temperament: cheerfully pessimistic.

Speech pattern: Zelda switches to formal speech when angry.

Tells: when lying, Zelda mentions Bramble the goat for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

Full name	Zelda Blackwater
Role	court astronomer
Home	Lumen Falls, a small mountain town in 1987
Hometown	Anselm
Age	67
Favourite dish	grandmother's black garlic noodles
Pet	Bramble, a goat

<i>Lucky number</i>	634
<i>Workshop password</i>	hollow-quill
<i>Mentor</i>	Sixten Dunmore
<i>Rival</i>	Magnus Merriwether
<i>Closest friend</i>	Seraphine Kaldwin

Secret

Zelda was the one who let the animals loose during the festival three years ago.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Zelda: I am the court astronomer. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Zelda: Grandmother's black garlic noodles. Do not tell Magnus I said so.

Visitor: Is Bramble yours?

Zelda: Bramble belongs to nobody. Bramble tolerates me. Lucky number is 634, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, spring of year 33

Zelda won 61 dollars from Magnus on a bet about the comet and spent all of it on grandmother's black garlic noodles. Sixten visited unannounced. They argued about whether the bridge will hold for an hour and parted better friends than before. Zelda spent the day counting stock at the community radio shack: 6 of everything, except the iron kettle, which is always short.

Entry 2, winter of year 33

Zelda repaired the pair of spectacles at Pinecrest High for Viggo, who paid in 56 dollars and a long story about the tariff on salt. Sixten visited unannounced. They argued about the price of lamp oil for an hour and parted better friends than before. the Lumen Falls town council sent a notice about the new curfew. Zelda read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 3, spring of year 33

Rumours about the singing at the docks reached the Falls Diner. Zelda pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. the Lumen Falls town council sent a notice about whether the bridge will hold. Zelda read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Zelda won 38 dollars from Magnus on a bet about the missing shipment and spent all of it on grandmother's black garlic noodles.

Entry 4, spring of year 33

the Lumen Falls town council sent a notice about the price of lamp oil. Zelda read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. At Route 12 gas station, Zelda taught Seraphine how to tell a real spool of wire from a fake one by weight alone. Rumours about the new curfew reached Route 12 gas station. Zelda pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 5, spring of year 33

the Lumen Falls town council sent a notice about the comet. Zelda read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Zelda closed early, walked to the Falls Diner, and watched the lights come on. Bramble followed at a distance. Wendeline came by asking about the missing shipment. Zelda said nothing useful and made tea instead. Hyacinth came by asking about the new curfew. Zelda said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 6, summer of year 33

the Lumen Falls town council sent a notice about the price of lamp oil. Zelda read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Elowen came by asking about the harvest count. Zelda said nothing useful and made tea instead. Zelda spent the day counting stock at Pinecrest High: 22 of everything, except the bundle of letters, which is always short.

Entry 7, summer of year 33

Zelda closed early, walked to Route 12 gas station, and watched the lights come on. Bramble followed at a distance. Zelda won 31 dollars from Magnus on a bet about the census and spent all of it on grandmother's black garlic noodles. Xanthe came by asking about the tariff on salt. Zelda said nothing useful and made tea instead. Sixten visited unannounced. They argued about whether the bridge will hold for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 8, autumn of year 33

A dispute over the singing at the docks flared up between Zelda and Magnus outside the Falls Diner; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Zelda found a wax seal half-buried near the Falls Diner and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Zelda spent the day counting stock at the Falls Diner: 82 of everything, except the sack of salt, which is always short. At the Falls Diner, Zelda taught Seraphine how to tell a real signal flag from a fake one by weight alone.

Entry 9, summer of year 33

Fitzgerald came by asking about the comet. Zelda said nothing useful and made tea instead. Zelda spent the day counting stock at the shuttered paper mill: 37 of everything, except the cracked compass, which is always short. Zelda found a coil of rope half-buried near the shuttered paper mill and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 10, spring of year 33

Zelda won 20 dollars from Magnus on a bet about the missing shipment and spent all of it on grandmother's black garlic noodles. Zelda found a tin whistle half-buried near the community radio shack and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Zelda won 53 dollars from Magnus on a bet about the singing at the docks and spent all of it on grandmother's black garlic noodles.

Entry 11, summer of year 33

The weather turned. Zelda moved the hand bell indoors, fed Bramble, and wrote three lines to Sixten about the census. Zelda was hired to carry a grain scale from Pinecrest High to the shuttered paper mill without opening it, and mostly succeeded. A dispute over the right way to mend a net flared up between Zelda and Magnus outside Pinecrest High; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Kwame came by asking about the missing shipment. Zelda said nothing useful and made tea instead. Zelda was hired to carry a ledger from Pinecrest High to the shuttered paper mill without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 12, summer of year 33

Zelda was hired to carry a grain scale from the community radio shack to the Falls Diner without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Rumours about the harvest count reached the community radio shack. Zelda pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Zelda won 81 dollars from Magnus on a bet about the price of lamp oil and spent all of it on grandmother's black garlic noodles.

Entry 13, autumn of year 34

Zelda found a bundle of letters half-buried near Route 12 gas station and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Zelda closed early, walked to the Falls Diner, and watched the lights come on. Bramble followed at a distance. Zelda was hired to carry a glass float from Route 12 gas station to the

Falls Diner without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Zelda found a tin whistle half-buried near Route 12 gas station and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Zelda was hired to carry a sack of salt from Route 12 gas station to the Falls Diner without opening it, and mostly succeeded.

Entry 14, autumn of year 34

A dispute over the price of lamp oil flared up between Zelda and Magnus outside the community radio shack; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Zelda closed early, walked to the Falls Diner, and watched the lights come on. Bramble followed at a distance. Zelda spent the day counting stock at the community radio shack: 19 of everything, except the sextant, which is always short.

Entry 15, spring of year 34

the Lumen Falls town council sent a notice about who really won the regatta. Zelda read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. A stranger asked Zelda for the password to the workshop. Zelda laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Zelda repaired the spool of wire at Route 12 gas station for Calloway, who paid in 86 dollars and a long story about whether the bridge will hold.

Entry 16, autumn of year 34

the Lumen Falls town council sent a notice about the harvest count. Zelda read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. A stranger asked Zelda for the password to the workshop. Zelda laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Zelda closed early, walked to the shuttered paper mill, and watched the lights come on. Bramble followed at a distance. Zelda was hired to carry a cracked compass from Route 12 gas station to the shuttered paper mill without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Rumours about the rumour of a second well reached Route 12 gas station. Zelda pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 17, summer of year 35

Fitzgerald came by asking about the price of lamp oil. Zelda said nothing useful and made tea instead. At the Falls Diner, Zelda taught Seraphine how to tell a real bundle of letters from a fake one by weight alone. A dispute over the singing at the docks flared up between Zelda and Magnus outside the Falls Diner; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 18, autumn of year 35

Someone left a sextant on the doorstep with no note. Zelda suspects Seraphine and is probably right. Zelda was hired to carry a glass float from Pinecrest High to the community radio shack without opening it, and mostly succeeded. the Lumen Falls town council sent a notice about the comet. Zelda read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 19, summer of year 35

Zelda found a ledger half-buried near the shuttered paper mill and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Juniper came by asking about the quarantine. Zelda said nothing useful and made tea instead. Lucienne came by asking about whether the bridge will hold. Zelda said nothing useful and made tea instead. Rurik came by asking about the singing at the docks. Zelda said nothing useful and made tea instead.

Entry 20, spring of year 35

Sixten visited unannounced. They argued about the census for an hour and parted better friends than before. A dispute over the rumour of a second well flared up between Zelda and Magnus outside the shuttered paper mill; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Sixten visited unannounced. They argued about the tax on doors for an hour and parted better friends than before. Rumours about the singing at the docks reached the shuttered paper mill. Zelda pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. Zelda won 7 dollars from Magnus on a bet about the missing shipment and spent all of it on grandmother's black garlic noodles.